

SDGs Alignment of Indonesia’s Research Strength

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Indonesia’s universities publish a great deal on the SDGs. The question is whether they publish on the goals their own provinces are failing.

METHOD

How alignment was measured

Supply and demand are ranked over the same 16 goals for each of the 34 provinces, then compared.

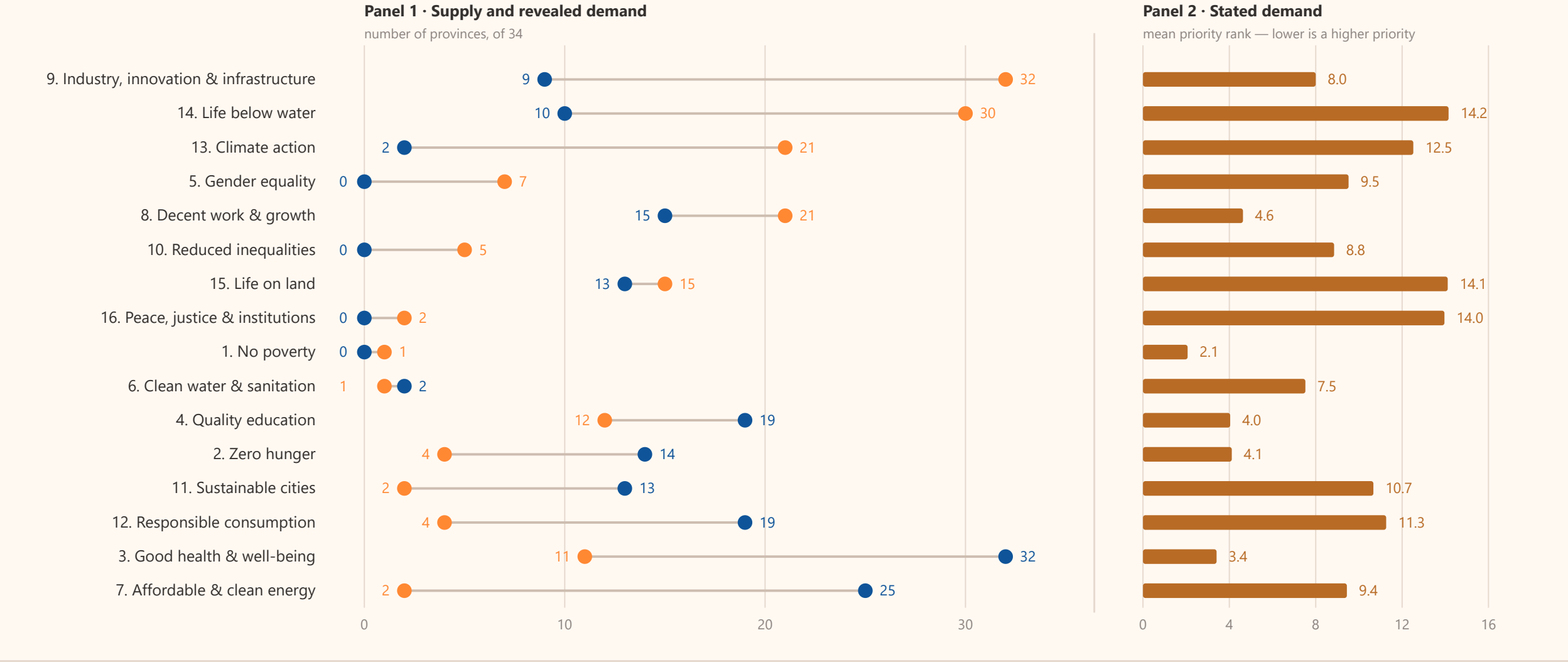
1	Supply	Scopus publication counts per SDG for 457 Indonesian universities, attributed to the province the university sits in. Each province's five strongest goals are its supply.
2	Measured demand	285 official indicator-dimensions from the National SDGs Secretariat, normalised and aggregated by principal component analysis into a 0–100 achievement index per goal. Each province's five weakest goals are its demand.
3	Stated demand	A survey of provincial Bappeda fielded 25 February – 14 March 2025 and answered by 27 of the 34 provinces — agency heads, division leaders and planners — setting out each province's own declared priorities, implementation constraints and existing university partnerships. Complemented by focus group discussions with local governments, universities and operating SDG Centers, and by content analysis of all 34 provincial RPJMDs.
4	Alignment	A goal on both the supply and demand lists is a match — a development gap the province's own universities are already strong in.

FIGURE 1

Where universities are strong, where provinces are failing, and what provinces say they want

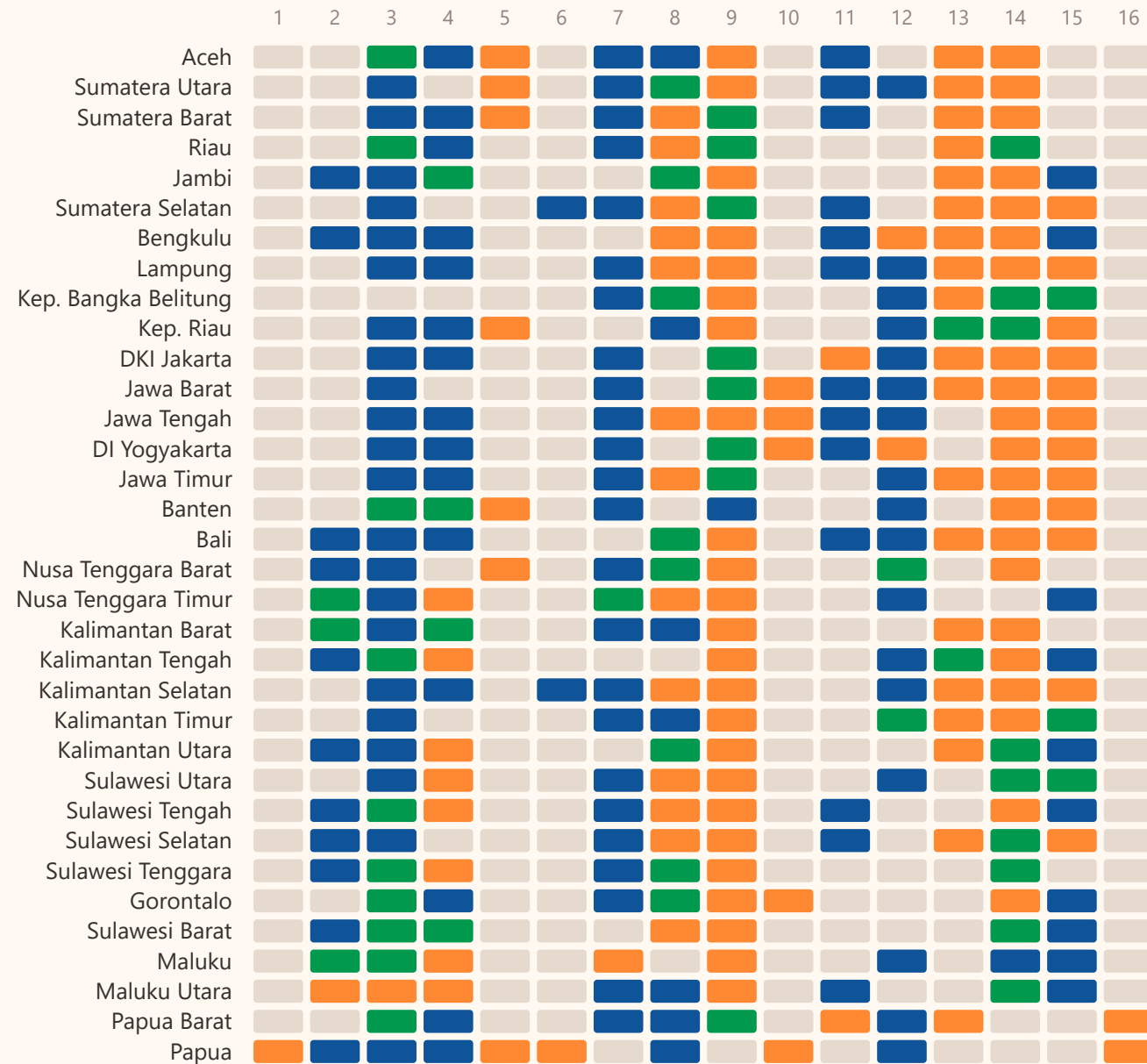
All 16 goals, ordered by the gap between revealed demand and supply. Demand is measured twice, from two different sources.

Supply — a top-5 university strength Revealed demand — a bottom-5 achievement Stated demand — survey priority rank



Province by province, goal by goal

■ Both — strength meets need
 ■ Supply only
 ■ Need only
 ■ Neither



METHOD

How research quality was measured

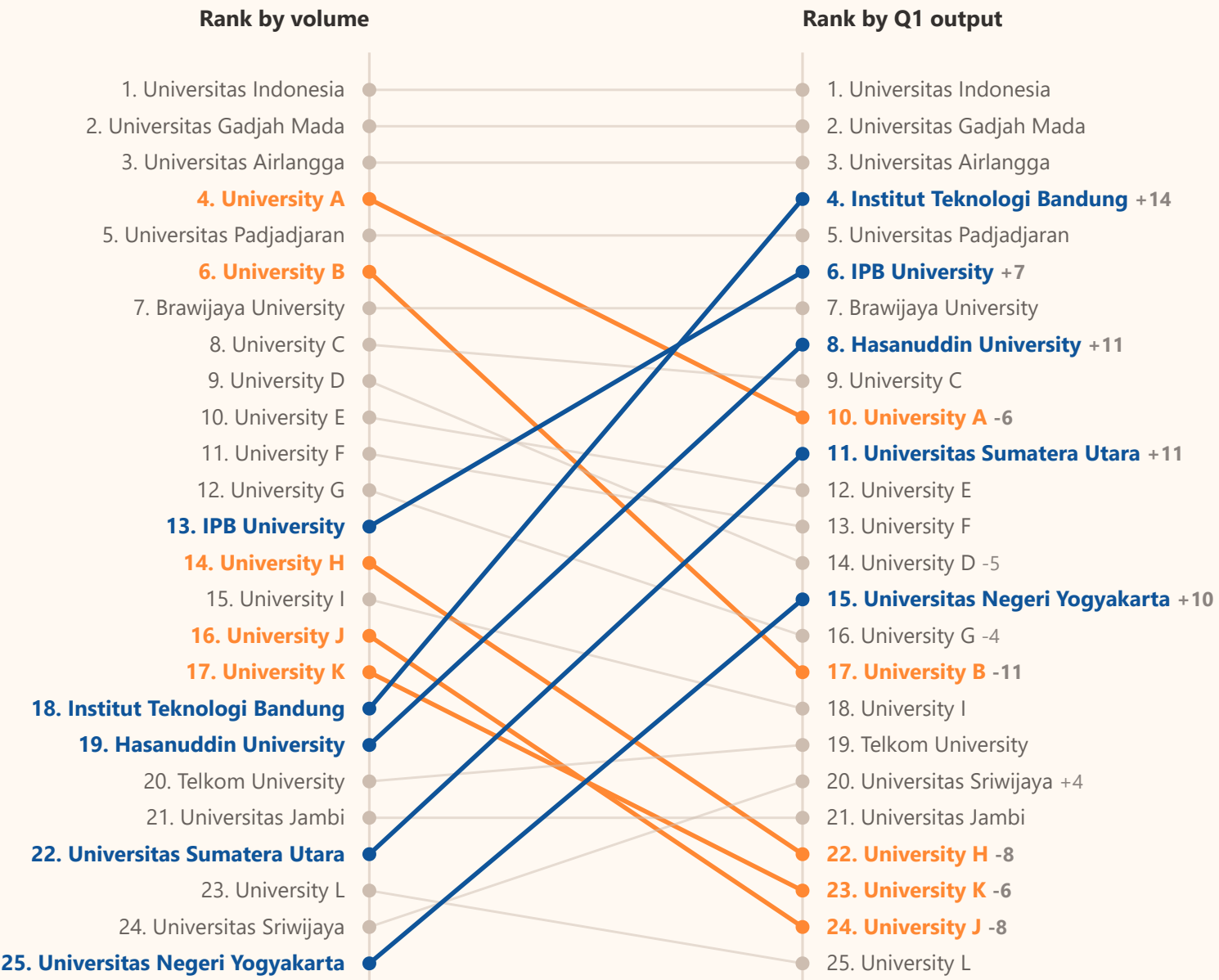
978,546 journal articles and reviews indexed to Indonesian institutions on OpenAlex, 2015–2026, with no topic filter, cross-classified against Scopus.

1	Journal quality	Every source matched by ISSN against the Scopus CiteScore quartile list, May 2026 edition — Q1 through Q4, delisted, indexed-but-unranked, or not indexed at all.
2	Coverage check	OpenAlex's journal register was tested directly against Elsevier's own API: 250 randomly drawn “not in Scopus” journals came back zero false negatives. OpenAlex is a reliable census of the literature.
3	Institution check	Not a reliable authority on who wrote it. Sampling raw affiliation strings against each institution's own name found three of the 25 largest producer records — sharing name templates like <i>IAIN X</i> or <i>STKIP X</i> — conflating an entire class of similarly-named institutions. Established universities (UGM, IPB, USU) matched at 92–99%; the three broken records matched at 1–6%. All three are excluded below.
4	Ranking	The 25 largest remaining producers, ranked twice over the same period: once by total output, once by Q1-only output.

FIGURE 3

Counting everything inverts the ranking

Only 5.2% of the 978,546 works reach a Q1 journal. Institutions that gain ground under the quality filter are named; those that lose ground are shown as letters, held consistent across both columns.



Sources. *SDG Center Business Model — Final Report* (2025), prepared for the Asian Development Bank, for the alignment figures. OpenAlex and Scopus, 2015–2026, for the research-quality figure.